concluding with the RSS prayer—prarthana—in Hindi and Marathi was instituted in 1926. See https://www.rss.org/Timeline.html.

2. Advani and Gupta's photo performing the RSS salute was published on page 1 of *The Times of India*, 16 October 2000. The RSS Prarthana, 'Namastee sada vatsale', is an ode to the Motherland in Sanskrit, with its last line in Hindi. It is compulsory to sing this prayer in all Sangh functions. It was first sung publicly by RSS pracharak Yadav Rao Joshi on 18 May 1940. Written by Narhar Narayan Bhide, the first line is, 'Namaste sada vatsale matribhume' ('Namaste, oh ever-loving Motherland'). The last line 'Bharat Mata ki jai' is in Hindi. Details from the RSS website, which also carries translations of the song in Kannada, Tamil, Malayalam and Bangla. See https://samvada.org/2015/news/75-years-for-rss-prarthana/. Full video of the RSS prayer, with Hindi translation, is available at: https://youtu.be/4Si8U02s8cQ.
3. Quoted in S. Prasannarajan, 'Vision Hindutva', *India Today*, 30 October 2000.
4. See, for instance, Rajesh Ramachandran, 'RSS leader lashes out at political class in his annual address', 14 October 2000; Dilip Chaware, 'No differences with NDA, says RSS chief', *The Times of India*, 20 November 2000.
5. Nalin Mehta, 'RSS show of strength in Agra', NDTV broadcast, 15 October 2000, recording in author's collection.
6. The RSS defines this term, based on Sanskrit words, as 'the topmost leader of the RSS revered and venerated as "Friend, Philosopher and Guide" by all'. See https://www.rss.org//Encyc/2017/6/3/basic-faq-on-rss-eng.html.
7. Quoted in S. Prasannarajan, 'Vision Hindutva', *India Today*, 30 October 2000.
8. Quoted in Bishakha De Sarkar, 'With friends like these', *The Telegraph*, 13 March 2000.
9. Vivek Deshpande interview of Ram Madhav, 'Second-class Citizenship (for Muslims) against Hindu ethos', *The Indian Express*, 16 March 2003.
10. Manini Chatterjee, 'Repackaging the RSS', *The Indian Express*, 16 March 2003.
11. Ibid.